



WGNI FARM

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

POULTRY OPERATIONS

FIELD	DETAIL
Document Title	Poultry Operations Standard Operating Procedure
Covers	Broilers and Turkey
Location	WGNI Farm, Abeokuta, Nigeria
Document Authority	CEO, WGNI Farm
Applies To	Poultry Worker and Farm Manager
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PART A POULTRY WORKER GUIDE

SECTION 1 ACCESS AND SECURITY

1.1 Padlock and Key

The poultry house should always be secured with a padlock. Only the assigned poultry worker and the Farm Manager hold a key. The padlock must be locked every time the worker steps out, even briefly.

1.2 Who May Enter

Only the assigned poultry worker and the Farm Manager are permitted inside the poultry house. No other person may enter under any circumstance. This includes farm workers from other units, visitors, buyers, family members, and management staff other than the Farm Manager. No exceptions.

1.3 Disinfection Protocol Disinfectant Bucket

A bucket of sodium hypochlorite solution must be always placed at the entrance of every poultry pen. Both the poultry worker and the Farm Manager must dip both feet fully in the bucket before stepping inside every single time.

- Approved disinfectants: Hypo, Jik, or any sodium hypochlorite-based product.
- Dilution: Mix 50ml to 75ml of disinfectant in 10 to 15 litres of clean water (one full bucket).
- The bucket solution must be replaced every two days or immediately when it becomes visibly dirty, cloudy, or heavily diluted.
- The bucket must never be removed from the entrance. If it is empty or unusable, refill it before anyone enters.

1.4 Boot Protocol One Boot Per Pen

Each poultry pen has its own dedicated pair of boots. These boots must not leave the pen area or be used in any other pen, including a second broiler pen of the same age or flock type.

- If the farm runs two broiler batches or two separate pens, each pen has its own dedicated boot. Boot A stays at Pen A. Boot B stays at Pen B. They do not cross.
- External boots, meaning any footwear worn outside the farm premises, are forbidden inside any poultry pen at any time.
- The dedicated boots are issued to the poultry worker and always kept at the pen entrance.

1.5 Isolation Protocol Sick Bay

Any bird identified as sick or behaving abnormally must be removed from the main flock immediately and placed in the designated isolation cage or pen.

- The isolation pen must have its own separate feeder and drinker.
- A separate pair of handling gloves must be kept at the isolation pen and used only there.
- No isolated bird is returned to the main flock under any circumstance, even if it appears to recover. The Farm Manager makes the final call.
- After handling an isolated bird, wash hands thoroughly before re-entering the main pen.

1.6 Entry Sequence Control

When managing more than one pen, always move in this order:

- Young birds first, then older birds.
- Healthy pen first, then suspect or isolation pen.
- Never reverse this order. Reversing the sequence risks carrying disease from an older or sicker flock to a younger or healthier one.

1.7 Personal Hygiene

- Wash hands with soap and water before entering and immediately after leaving any pen.
- Workers who are ill fever, cough, diarrhoea, or visible skin infection must report to the Farm Manager and must not enter any poultry pen until medically cleared.

SECTION 2 MORNING ROUTINE (7:00 AM)

- 2.1** Arrive at the poultry unit. Put on the dedicated pen boots. Dip both boots fully in the Disinfectant bucket. Wash hands with soap and water.
- 2.2** Unlock the padlock. Enter the pen.
- 2.3** Conduct the full Morning Observation Walkthrough. See Section 5.
- 2.4** Remove any dead birds immediately using gloves. Bag and take to the mortality disposal point. Report every death to the Farm Manager before 8:00 AM without fail.
- 2.5** Empty, rinse, and refill all drinkers with clean fresh water. Do not just top up, rinse first.
- 2.6** Before feeding, inspect the feed. Smell it, check its texture, and look for clumping or mould. No feed enters the feeder without passing this check. If the feed fails, remove it and report to the Farm Manager immediately.
- 2.7** Remove any wet, leftover, or mouldy feed from feeders. Then give the morning feed. See Section 6: Feed Guide.
- 2.8** Check ventilation. Open vents or curtains as appropriate for weather and temperature.
- 2.9** Fill in the morning entries on Form A.
- 2.10** Step out. Lock the padlock.

SECTION 3 MIDDAY HEAT CHECK (12:00 PM - 2:00 PM)

- 3.1** Dip boots. Wash hands. Enter the pen.
- 3.2** Check for signs of heat stress in the flock. See the behaviour guide in Section 5.8.
- 3.3** Check all drinkers. If water level is low, refill immediately. Birds under heat stress consume significantly more water than normal.
- 3.4** If birds are panting with wings spread away from the body, report to the Farm Manager immediately. Do not wait for the evening routine.
- 3.5** Do not feed during the midday check. Feeding during peak heat increases metabolic heat and worsens stress.
- 3.6** Step out. Lock the padlock. Note any heat stress observations in Form A.

SECTION 4 EVENING ROUTINE (5:00 PM)

- 4.1 Put** on pen boots. Dip both boots in the Disinfectant bucket. Wash hands. Unlock and enter.
- 4.2 Conduct** the full Evening Observation Walkthrough. See Section 5.
- 4.3** Report any deaths or newly sick birds found during the evening walkthrough to the Farm Manager immediately. Do not wait until the next morning.
- 4.4** Top up all drinkers with clean water. Birds must not be without water overnight.
- 4.5** Inspect the evening feed before giving it. Remove uneaten or wet feed from feeders first. Then give the evening feed. See Section 6: Feed Guide.
- 4.6** Close and secure vents and curtains appropriately for the night temperature.
- 4.7** Fill in the evening entries on Form A.

4.8 Step out. Lock the padlock. Hand Form A to the Farm Manager for daily review and signature.

SECTION 5 OBSERVATION WALKTHROUGH

Carry out this walkthrough every time you enter a pen, both morning and evening. Walk slowly. Look at every bird in every section. Do not rush.

5.1 Stand at the entrance before moving in. Listen. Note any unusual sounds, excessive distress calls, unusual silence, or a smell significantly stronger than normal.

5.2 Walk slowly from one end of the pen to the other. Cover every row and every corner. Do not check from one spot.

5.3 Look at the floor as you walk. Check for:

- Dead birds lying flat.
- Bloody, watery, or green droppings.
- Wet or heavily soiled litter in specific areas.
- Spilled or uneaten feed on the floor.

5.4 Look at the birds as you walk. Check for:

- Any bird sitting alone away from the flock.
- Any bird that is not moving when others move.
- Any bird with a drooping head, drooping wings, or laboured breathing.
- Swelling around the face, eyes, or joints.
- Any bird gasping, coughing, or sneezing repeatedly.
- Groups of birds piling into one corner.

5.5 Look at the flock as a whole. Check for:

- Are the birds active and moving toward feeders?
- Is the flock evenly spread across the pen or crowded in one area?
- Does the overall energy of the flock seem normal compared to yesterday?

5.6 Check drinkers.

- Are they full? Is the water clean? Is there any slime, algae, or discolouration?
- If feed intake appears to have dropped by more than 10 percent compared to the previous day, report to the Farm Manager immediately.

5.7 Check feeders.

- Is there leftover wet feed? Any signs of mould or unusual smell from the feed?

5.8 Check pen structure.

Any torn netting, broken panels, open gaps, or damage to walls or roof? Report immediately. Do not attempt repair yourself.

Table 5.1 Behaviour-Based Temperature Guide

Bird Behaviour	Meaning	Immediate Action
Birds clustered tightly together	Pen is too cold	Increase heat source. Check curtains and vents.
Birds spread far from centre, near walls	Pen is too hot	Reduce heat. Open vents. Check water immediately.
Birds panting with wings spread	Severe heat stress	Report to Farm Manager immediately. Increase water urgently.

Bird Behaviour	Meaning	Immediate Action
Birds evenly spread across pen	Correct temperature	Maintain current conditions.

5.9 2-Hour Rule.

Any abnormal bird must be isolated or reported to the Farm Manager within 2 hours of observation. Do not wait until the end of the session. In a disease outbreak, 2 hours can be the difference between one sick bird and a flock-wide infection.

5.10

Once done, note everything observed in Form A. Use Section 8 to decide what action to take and when.

SECTION 6 FEED GUIDE

Feed is split equally between morning and evening sessions. All quantities below are the total daily amount per 100 birds. Adjust proportionally for your actual flock size.

Anti-Sudden Death Rule (Week 4 to Week 8): During the fast-growth phase, never dump the full feed amount at once. Distribute evenly across feeders. Ensure constant clean water is available at all times. Sudden death syndrome is a real risk when birds are overfed in a single sitting during rapid growth.

6.1 BROILERS Full Growth Cycle (Week 1 to Week 8)

Week	Feed Type	Daily / 100 Birds	Daily / Bird	Weekly / 100 Birds	Weekly / Bird	Bags / 100 Birds	Bags / Bird
Week 1	Starter	5 kg	0.05 kg	35 kg	0.35 kg	1.4 bags	0.014
Week 2	Starter	8 kg	0.08 kg	56 kg	0.56 kg	2.24 bags	0.022
Week 3	Grower	12 kg	0.12 kg	84 kg	0.84 kg	3.36 bags	0.034
Week 4	Grower	16 kg	0.16 kg	112 kg	1.12 kg	4.48 bags	0.045
Week 5	Finisher	20 kg	0.20 kg	140 kg	1.40 kg	5.6 bags	0.056
Week 6	Finisher	23 kg	0.23 kg	161 kg	1.61 kg	6.44 bags	0.064
Week 7	Finisher	25 kg	0.25 kg	175 kg	1.75 kg	7.0 bags	0.070
Week 8	Finisher	27 kg	0.27 kg	189 kg	1.89 kg	7.56 bags	0.076
TOTAL	Week 1-8			952 kg	9.52 kg	approx. 38 bags	approx. 0.38

Table 6.1a Broiler Phase Breakdown per 100 Birds

Phase	Weeks	Total kg	Total Bags (25 kg each)
Starter	Week 1 - 2	91 kg	approx. 4 bags
Grower	Week 3 - 4	196 kg	approx. 8 bags
Finisher	Week 5 - 8	665 kg	approx. 27 bags
TOTAL	Week 1 - 8	952 kg	approx. 38 bags

Table 6.1b Broiler Feed Per Single Bird

Phase	kg per Bird	Bags per Bird
Starter	0.91 kg	0.036 bags
Grower	1.96 kg	0.078 bags
Finisher	6.65 kg	0.266 bags
TOTAL	9.52 kg	approx. 0.38 bags

6.2 TURKEY Full Growth Cycle (Week 1 to Week 12)

Week	Feed Type	Daily / 100 Birds	Daily / Bird	Weekly / 100 Birds	Weekly / Bird	Bags / 100 Birds	Bags / Bird
Week 1	Starter 28%	7 kg	0.07 kg	49 kg	0.49 kg	1.96 bags	0.020
Week 2	Starter 28%	10 kg	0.10 kg	70 kg	0.70 kg	2.80 bags	0.028
Week 3	Starter 28%	14 kg	0.14 kg	98 kg	0.98 kg	3.92 bags	0.039
Week 4	Grower 22%	18 kg	0.18 kg	126 kg	1.26 kg	5.04 bags	0.050
Week 5	Grower 22%	23 kg	0.23 kg	161 kg	1.61 kg	6.44 bags	0.064
Week 6	Grower 22%	28 kg	0.28 kg	196 kg	1.96 kg	7.84 bags	0.078
Week 7	Grower 22%	33 kg	0.33 kg	231 kg	2.31 kg	9.24 bags	0.092
Week 8	Finisher 18%	38 kg	0.38 kg	266 kg	2.66 kg	10.64 bags	0.106
Week 9	Finisher 18%	42 kg	0.42 kg	294 kg	2.94 kg	11.76 bags	0.118
Week 10	Finisher 18%	46 kg	0.46 kg	322 kg	3.22 kg	12.88 bags	0.129
Week 11	Finisher 18%	49 kg	0.49 kg	343 kg	3.43 kg	13.72 bags	0.137
Week 12	Finisher 18%	52 kg	0.52 kg	364 kg	3.64 kg	14.56 bags	0.146
TOTAL	Week 1-12			2,520 kg	25.20 kg	approx. 101 bags	approx. 1.01

Table 6.2a Turkey Phase Breakdown per 100 Birds

Phase	Weeks	Total kg	Total Bags (25 kg each)
Starter (28% protein)	Week 1 - 3	217 kg	approx. 9 bags
Grower (22% protein)	Week 4 - 7	714 kg	approx. 29 bags
Finisher (18% protein)	Week 8 - 12	1,589 kg	approx. 64 bags
TOTAL	Week 1 - 12	2,520 kg	approx. 101 bags

Table 6.2b Turkey Feed Per Single Bird

Phase	kg per Bird	Bags per Bird
Starter	2.17 kg	0.087 bags
Grower	7.14 kg	0.286 bags
Finisher	15.89 kg	0.636 bags
TOTAL	25.20 kg	approx. 1 bag per bird

6.3 Feeding Rules

- Never mix broiler feed and turkey feed.
- Always inspect feed before giving it: smell it, check its texture, look for clumping or mould. No feed enters the feeder without passing this check.
- If feed intake drops by more than 10 percent compared to the previous day, report to the Farm Manager immediately.

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- Discard any feed that fails the quality check. Report to the Farm Manager immediately.
- Do not overfill feeders. Spilled feed on the floor breeds bacteria and attracts pests.
- Do not add extra feed between scheduled times without the Farm Manager's instruction.

SECTION 7 SAWDUST AND LITTER QUALITY

7.1 What is Acceptable

Sawdust used as litter must be of good visible particle size. Each piece must be identifiable and distinct. Acceptable sawdust is dry, light brown or golden in colour, and has a clean woody smell.

7.2 What to Reject

- In powder or dust form. If it cannot be picked up and seen as individual particles, it is too fine.
- Wet, damp, or clumped together on arrival.
- Dark in colour, which may indicate prior use or moisture exposure.
- Carrying a foul, sour, or chemical smell.
- Mixed with foreign materials such as stones, plastic, or bark chunks.

7.3 Simple Moisture Test

Take a handful of litter and squeeze it firmly in your fist.

- If it forms a solid ball when you open your hand, it is too wet. Report to the Farm Manager immediately.
- If it scatters and breaks apart easily, it is acceptable.

7.4 Ammonia Trigger Rule

If you can smell ammonia at nose level when you enter the pen, report to the Farm Manager before proceeding with any other task. High ammonia levels damage the respiratory system of birds and accelerate disease spread.

7.5 What to Do on Delivery

- Inspect every bag or load of sawdust before it enters the pen.
- If a delivery does not meet the standard in Section 7.1, reject it and notify the Farm Manager before use.
- Do not use substandard sawdust because there is no other available. Report the shortage to the Farm Manager.

7.6 Litter Management

- Spread sawdust evenly across the pen floor at the depth instructed by the Farm Manager.
- Turn litter regularly to prevent caking and moisture build-up in high-traffic areas.
- Replace wet, heavily soiled, or compacted sections immediately. Do not wait for the weekly cleaning day.
- Record every sawdust replenishment in Form A.

SECTION 8 OBSERVATION STANDARDS

Table 8.1 Observation Standards and Response Guide

What You See	Observation	Next Action	When
Bird lying flat, not moving	Dead bird	Remove with gloves. Bag. Dispose at mortality point. Record on Form C. Report to Farm Manager.	Immediately
Bird sitting alone, away from flock	Likely sick or weak	Isolate in sick bay. Report to Farm Manager within 2 hours.	Within 2 hours
Bird not eating or drinking	Stress, illness, or feed problem	Check feed and water quality. If both fine, report to Farm Manager.	Same session
Watery, green, or bloody droppings	Possible infection or coccidiosis	Do not clean yet. Show Farm Manager first.	Immediately
Swollen face, eyes, or joints	Bacterial or respiratory infection	Isolate bird. Do not handle further. Report immediately.	Immediately
Bird gasping, coughing, or sneezing	Respiratory disease spreads fast	Isolate bird. Report to Farm Manager. Do not wait.	Immediately
Birds all piling into one corner	Too cold, draught, or poor ventilation	Check vents and temperature. Report to Farm Manager.	Before leaving pen
Birds panting with wings spread	Severe heat stress	Report immediately. Increase water urgently.	Immediately
Strong ammonia smell at nose level	Wet litter or disease build-up	Report to Farm Manager immediately.	Immediately
Sudden drop in feed consumption	Illness, stress, or bad feed	Check feed quality. Report to Farm Manager.	Same day
Feed intake down more than 10% vs yesterday	Early health or feed warning	Report to Farm Manager immediately.	Immediately
Mortality over 2 birds in one day	Mortality threshold breach	Report to Farm Manager immediately. Vet contact triggered.	Immediately
Weight loss since last weighing	Feed issue, illness, or parasite	Report to Farm Manager immediately.	Immediately
Drinker empty or water dirty	Water supply issue	Refill or rinse immediately. Report if recurring.	Immediately
Feeder empty before next scheduled feed	Underfeeding issue	Report to Farm Manager. Do not add feed without instruction.	Same session
Damaged netting, panels, or gaps	Predator entry risk	Report to Farm Manager. Do not attempt repair.	Immediately
Disinfectant bucket empty or visibly dirty	Biosecurity risk	Refill with fresh solution before anyone enters.	Immediately
Dusty, wet, or compacted litter	Litter quality problem	Do the hand squeeze test. Report result to Farm Manager.	Same day
Litter forms a ball when squeezed	Litter too wet	Report to Farm Manager before next entry.	Same day

SECTION 9 WEIGHT MONITORING

9.1 Birds are to be weighed twice a week on days set by the Farm Manager.

9.2 Weighing Procedure

- Randomly select 5 to 10 birds from different parts of the pen. Do not pick from the same spot every time.
- Weigh each bird individually on the farm scale.
- Record each individual weight on Form B.
- Calculate the average: add all weights together and divide by the number of birds weighed.
Example: 10 birds totalling 24 kg gives an average of 2.4 kg per bird.

Table 9.1 Expected Weight Benchmarks

Week	Broiler Target (Avg per Bird)	Turkey Target (Avg per Bird)
Week 1	0.17 kg	0.12 kg
Week 2	0.40 kg	0.28 kg
Week 3	0.80 kg	0.55 kg
Week 4	1.30 kg	0.95 kg
Week 5	1.80 kg	1.50 kg
Week 6	2.30 kg	2.10 kg
Week 7	2.80 kg	2.80 kg
Week 8	3.20 kg	3.60 kg
Week 9	N/A	4.40 kg
Week 10	N/A	5.30 kg
Week 11	N/A	6.20 kg
Week 12	N/A	7.00 kg

Table 9.2 Weighing Result Response Guide

Result	Next Action	When
At or above benchmark	Continue feeding. Record and report on Form A.	Evening report same day
Up to 10% below benchmark	Flag to Farm Manager in evening report. Continue feeding as normal.	Evening report same day
More than 10% below benchmark	Report to Farm Manager immediately. Do not adjust feed without instruction.	Immediately
Weight loss vs last weighing	Report to Farm Manager immediately. Possible illness or feed problem.	Immediately

SECTION 10 DEAD BIRD HANDLING

10.1 Always use gloves. Never handle a carcass with bare hands.

10.2 Place in a sealed bag or covered container immediately upon discovery.

10.3 Take directly to the designated mortality disposal point. Not the bush, drainage, open ground, or anywhere else on the farm.

10.4 Post-Mortem Observation

Before bagging the carcass, note and record on Form C any visible signs:

- Enlarged or discoloured internal organs if carcass is open.
- Presence of blood in the body cavity.
- Unusual smell beyond normal decomposition.
- Visible external lesions, discolouration, or swelling.

These observations help the Vet diagnose the cause remotely.

10.5 Record on Form C: date, time found, pen, type of bird, flock age in weeks, visible signs, and disposal confirmation.

10.6 Report every death to the Farm Manager. Morning deaths before 8:00 AM, evening deaths immediately upon discovery.

SECTION 11 CLEANING SCHEDULE

11.1 Daily

- Rinse and refill all drinkers every morning before feeding.
- Clean feeders before each feed. Remove wet, leftover, or mouldy feed.
- Remove droppings and wet litter from the pen floor.
- Refresh the Disinfectant bucket every two days or when visibly dirty.

11.2 Weekly Every Saturday

- Full litter inspection. Remove and replace wet or heavily soiled sections.
- Disinfect all drinkers and feeders with fresh Disinfectant solution.
- Wash down the area immediately outside the pen entrance.
- Farm Manager conducts the formal weekly cleanliness inspection and signs Form D.

11.3 Between Flocks Full Cleanout

- Remove all birds, litter, feeders, drinkers, and equipment from the pen.
- Scrub all surfaces floor, walls, and ceiling with detergent and water.
- Apply full Disinfectant disinfection to all surfaces and equipment.
- Rest the pen for a minimum of 7 days before introducing the next flock. A rest period of 10 to 14 days is the recommended target where capacity allows.

SECTION 12 SLAUGHTER AND PROCESSING

12.1 Slaughter is carried out only on the Farm Manager's written or direct verbal instruction. No bird is removed from the pen for slaughter without this authorisation.

12.2 Slaughter is never done inside the poultry house. It is carried out only at the designated processing area.

12.3 Before Slaughter

- Withhold feed from birds for 6 to 8 hours before slaughter. Water may continue.
- Confirm the exact number of birds to be slaughtered with the Farm Manager before removing any bird.
- Record on Form E: date, number of birds, pen, flock age in weeks.

12.4 Slaughter Procedure

- Always handle birds calmly. No dragging, throwing, or rough handling.
- Use a clean, sharp knife only. Wash and disinfect the knife with Disinfectant solution before use.
- Allow birds to bleed out fully before proceeding.

12.5 Plucking and Dressing

- Scald birds in hot water (60 to 65 degrees Celsius) for 30 to 60 seconds to loosen feathers.
- Pluck immediately after scalding. Remove all feathers thoroughly.
- Open the carcass cleanly. Remove all internal organs without puncturing the intestines.
- If the intestine is punctured, stop immediately. Report to the Farm Manager. Do not continue without instruction.
- Separate edible organs (gizzard, liver, heart) from waste organs. Rinse edible organs with clean water.
- Wash the dressed carcass thoroughly with clean water.

12.6 After Processing

- Feathers, blood, and waste organs must be disposed of at the designated waste point immediately.
- Wash the processing area down with clean water and disinfect with Disinfectant solution after every session.
- Wash, disinfect, and store all processing tools properly after use.
- Record on Form E: number of birds processed, dressed weight if weighed, and any internal observations.

12.7 Handling Dressed Birds

- Place dressed birds in clean, food-safe bags or containers immediately.
- Do not leave dressed birds at room temperature for more than 2 hours.
- If not for immediate sale or delivery, refrigerate or ice the birds promptly.
- Dressed birds must never be placed on bare ground or an unclean surface.

SECTION 13 EMERGENCY RESPONSE PROTOCOL

13.1 Stop all movement between pens immediately. Do not enter any other pen until the Farm Manager has assessed the situation.

13.2 Isolate every bird showing symptoms into the sick bay. Do not leave any abnormal bird in the main flock.

13.3 Check and record the following immediately: feed condition, water condition, pen temperature, litter condition, ventilation status, and time of first observation.

13.4 Report to the Farm Manager immediately with all recorded information. Do not wait.

13.5 The Farm Manager contacts the Vet. See Section 18: Vaccination and Treatment.

13.6 Record everything on Form C and Form A. Include time of first observation, number of birds affected, symptoms, and every action taken.

13.7 Do not resume normal operations between pens until the Farm Manager gives the all-clear.

SECTION 14 HEAT STRESS PROTOCOL

14.1 Signs of Heat Stress

- Birds panting with beaks open.
- Wings spread away from the body.
- Birds moving slowly or unable to stand.
- Significant drop in feed consumption.
- Birds crowding near the walls or ventilation points.

14.2 Immediate Response

- Increase water access immediately. Add extra drinkers if available.
- Open all vents, curtains, and available ventilation points.
- Do not feed during peak heat (12PM to 2PM).
- Report to the Farm Manager immediately if panting and wing-spreading is observed.

14.3 Farm Manager Actions on Heat Stress

- Authorise the addition of electrolytes to water if approved by the Vet or management.
- Reduce feed quantity temporarily during peak heat periods.
- Ensure continuous water availability. Birds under heat stress can die within hours without water.
- Record the event on Form A and note any mortality that follows.

SECTION 15 PEST CONTROL

15.1 Rodent Control

- Inspect the pen perimeter weekly for signs of rodent activity: droppings, gnaw marks, or burrow holes near the foundation.
- Report any rodent signs to the Farm Manager immediately.
- Feed must never be left in open bags on the floor. Store all feed in sealed containers or on raised pallets.
- Rodent traps or bait stations are placed and maintained by the Farm Manager only.

15.2 Fly Control

- Wet litter and uncovered feed are the primary causes of fly infestation. Keep both under control.
- Fly traps or sticky boards are placed at the pen entrance and replaced when full.
- Mortality disposal must be prompt. Exposed carcasses attract flies rapidly.
- Report any significant fly increase to the Farm Manager. It is usually a sign of a hygiene or litter problem.

15.3 General Pest Rule

Keeping the pen clean, dry, and sealed is the first line of pest control. A clean pen rarely has a severe pest problem. Pests carry disease into the pen. Rodents eat and contaminate feed. Flies spread pathogens between pens.

PART B FARM MANAGER GUIDE

SECTION 16 DAILY MANAGER RESPONSIBILITIES

16.1 Collect Form A from the poultry worker every evening without fail. Review all entries, sign against that day's entry, and transfer the data to Notion before 7:00 PM.

16.2 Follow up on every flagged observation, sick bird report, abnormal weight result, or missed entry before the next morning routine begins.

16.3 Confirm the padlock is secured on each pen during evening rounds.

16.4 Confirm the Disinfectant bucket at each pen entrance is in proper condition during evening rounds.

16.5 At the end of each week on Sunday, sign the final weekly signature at the bottom of Form A before filing.

SECTION 17 FARM MANAGER BIRD GUIDELINES

17.1 Flock Assessment on Arrival New Batch

Before accepting a new batch of birds, the Farm Manager must inspect the delivery. Check for:

- Uniformity: birds should be similar in size. Excessive size variation at day one is a red flag.
- Activity: day-old chicks should be alert, vocal, and moving. Lethargic or silent chicks on arrival indicate poor hatchery conditions.
- Physical condition: no visible deformities, no bleeding navels, no pasted vents.
- Count: confirm the number delivered matches the number ordered before signing any delivery note.
- Brooding setup must be complete and at correct temperature before birds enter the pen. Never receive birds into an unprepared pen.

17.2 Brooding Management First Two Weeks

The first two weeks are the most critical phase of the entire cycle. The Farm Manager must personally supervise brooding conditions.

- Week 1 temperature target: 32 to 34 degrees Celsius directly under the heat source.
- Week 2 temperature target: 29 to 32 degrees Celsius.
- Reduce heat gradually. Never remove heat suddenly.
- Read bird behaviour to assess temperature. See Table 5.1.
- Ventilation during brooding must be carefully balanced. Too much airflow chills chicks. Too little causes ammonia build-up.
- Ensure feed and water are placed very close to the heat source in Week 1 so chicks can reach them without moving far from warmth.

17.3 Flock Uniformity Monitoring

- Calculate uniformity: count how many of the weighed birds fall within 10 percent above or below the average weight. Divide by total birds weighed and multiply by 100.
- A uniformity score above 80 percent is good. Below 70 percent requires investigation.
- Identify and separate runts into a separate section with easier access to feed and water.
- Poor uniformity is usually caused by feeder and drinker space problems, density issues, or an early undetected health event.

17.4 Density Management

As birds grow they need more space. Overcrowding causes poor performance, heat stress, and disease spread.

Table 17.1 Recommended Stocking Density

Growth Phase	Recommended Floor Space per Bird
Week 1 to Week 2 (Broilers)	0.05 square metres per bird
Week 3 to Week 4 (Broilers)	0.10 square metres per bird
Week 5 to Week 8 (Broilers)	0.15 square metres per bird
Turkey (all phases)	0.25 to 0.40 square metres per bird

- If the pen becomes overcrowded as birds grow, the Farm Manager must make the call to separate or thin the flock.
- Never allow crowding to persist. It triggers heat stress, feed competition, and rapid disease spread.

17.5 Water Quality and Consumption Monitoring

- Monitor actual water consumption patterns across the week. A sudden drop is often the earliest sign of a health problem, appearing even before a drop in feed consumption.
- Check the water source quality periodically. Ensure storage tanks or boreholes are clean and uncontaminated.
- During hot weather, water consumption increases significantly. Ensure supply is adequate before heat peaks.
- Medicated water must be prepared exactly as directed by the Vet and removed after the prescribed treatment period.

17.6 Feed Transition Management

Every transition between feed phases must be managed gradually over 2 to 3 days. An abrupt switch causes digestive stress and can trigger a performance dip or mortality spike.

Table 17.2 Feed Transition Schedule

Day	Old Feed	New Feed
Day 1 of transition	75 percent	25 percent
Day 2 of transition	50 percent	50 percent
Day 3 of transition	25 percent	75 percent
Day 4 onward	0 percent	100 percent

- Never run out of the old feed before the new feed arrives. Plan transitions in advance.
- Record every feed transition on Form A.

17.7 FCR Feed Conversion Ratio

The Farm Manager calculates FCR weekly to assess feeding efficiency across the cycle.

Formula: $\text{FCR} = \text{Total Feed Consumed (kg)} \div \text{Total Weight Gained (kg)}$

Example: 100 birds consumed 200 kg of feed and gained 100 kg in body weight. $\text{FCR} = 2.0$. The lower the FCR, the more efficiently the flock is converting feed into body weight.

Table 17.3 FCR Interpretation Guide

FCR Range	Interpretation	Action Required
Below 1.8	Excellent	Maintain current feeding program.
1.8 to 2.0	Good	Monitor closely. No change required.
2.0 to 2.3	Average	Review feed quality and feeding routine.
Above 2.3	Poor	Escalate to management. Investigate feed, health, and environment.

- Calculate FCR at the end of each week using cumulative totals from Form A.

- Record FCR weekly and include it in any report to management.

17.8 Pre-Harvest Assessment

- Confirm birds have reached target weight using the most recent Form B data.
- Visually inspect the flock for health and activity. No lethargic or visibly sick birds may be sold.
- Confirm all medication withdrawal periods have been observed. No bird under withdrawal may be sold or slaughtered.
- Record the pre-harvest assessment outcome on Form E before any processing begins.

17.9 Flock Stress Triggers Manager Awareness

Table 17.4 Stress Triggers and Management Response

Stress Trigger	Effect on Flock	Farm Manager Response
Sudden loud noise near pen	Panic, piling, injuries	Inspect flock immediately. Check for injuries. Allow flock to settle before next entry.
Introduction of unfamiliar person or smell	Agitation, reduced feed intake	Reinforce access restriction. Monitor feed intake for 24 hours.
Predator presence near pen	Panic, piling, reduced water intake	Secure perimeter. Inspect for gaps. Monitor flock closely for 48 hours.
Abrupt weather change	Temperature stress, huddling or panting	Adjust ventilation immediately. Check water and litter.
Vaccination event	Temporary stress, drop in feed intake	Expect 1 to 2 days of reduced feed intake. Monitor closely. Ensure water is adequate.
Abrupt feed change	Digestive stress, drop in performance	Follow transition schedule in Table 17.2. Never switch feed abruptly.

17.10 End of Cycle Flock Evaluation

When the cycle is complete the Farm Manager conducts a final bird performance review before the next flock is introduced.

- Did the flock hit target weight by the intended harvest week?
- Was cumulative mortality within acceptable range (below 5 percent for broilers)?
- Were there any recurring health issues across the cycle?
- How did FCR trend across the cycle? Did it worsen in any specific week?
- What feeding, litter, or environmental issues recurred?
- What should be done differently in the next cycle?

This evaluation is submitted to the CEO as a written summary before the next flock is stocked.

SECTION 18 VACCINATION AND TREATMENT

18.1 General Rule

No drug, vaccine, or supplement may be administered to any bird without management approval. This applies to the Farm Manager and any other person on the farm without exception.

18.2 Standard Approval Process

- Step 1: Document the observation. Record the date, pen, number of birds affected, visible symptoms, and any relevant history.
- Step 2: Find and contact an available Vet Doctor. Describe the situation in full.
- Step 3: Receive the Vet's recommendation. Document the Vet's name, date and time of contact, and what was recommended.
- Step 4: If the Vet is not immediately available, the Farm Manager may form a recommendation based on experience. This must still go to management for approval before anything is administered.
- Step 5: Present the recommendation to management for approval. Nothing is administered until approval is granted.
- Step 6: Once approval is granted, administer exactly as recommended. Any change requires a return to the Vet or management before proceeding.

18.3 Emergency Situations

In a clear emergency where the health of the entire flock is at immediate risk and neither the Vet nor management can be reached instantly, the Farm Manager may act provisionally using only previously documented treatment references for similar symptoms. The Farm Manager must notify both the Vet and management within the same hour and document every action taken on Form F.

18.4 What Requires Management Approval

- Any drug recommended by the Vet.
- Any drug recommended by the Farm Manager, with or without Vet input.
- Any vaccine, supplement, or additive regardless of source.
- Any dosage adjustment from a previously approved treatment.

18.5 What is Never Permitted

- Administering any drug, vaccine, or supplement before management approval is received.
- Using leftover drugs from a previous flock without Vet reconfirmation and fresh management approval.
- Accepting drug recommendations from feed store vendors, neighbours, or other farmers without going through the full process in Section 18.2.
- Adjusting dosage or method without going back through the approval process.

18.6 Cold Chain Rule Drug/Vaccine Storage

Drugs / Vaccines must be stored at room temperature. Never expose vaccines to direct sunlight or heat. Once a drug is opened, it must be used within the timeframe specified on the packaging. Expired or improperly stored vaccines are ineffective and may harm the flock.

18.7 Vaccination Schedule

A standard vaccination schedule is to be obtained from the Vet at the beginning of each flock cycle. The Farm Manager is responsible for ensuring every vaccination is administered on the correct date, recorded on Form F, and reported to management.

18.8 Withdrawal Periods

Withdrawal periods must be strictly observed before any medicated birds are slaughtered or sold. The Farm Manager is solely responsible for tracking and communicating withdrawal deadlines to any party involved in slaughter or sales.

SECTION 19 WEEKLY CLEANLINESS INSPECTION

19.1 Every Saturday, after the worker completes the weekly cleaning, the Farm Manager conducts a formal inspection of every poultry pen before signing Form D.

Table 19.1 Weekly Cleanliness Inspection Checklist

Area	What to Check	Acceptable Standard
Floor	Droppings, wet litter, debris	Dry, clean, no visible droppings
Drinkers	Cleanliness, water quality, condition	Clean, no slime or algae, filled with fresh water
Feeders	Leftover feed, moisture, mould	Clean, dry, no residue
Walls and Ceiling	Cobwebs, dust, mould	Visibly clean, no build-up
Disinfectant Bucket	Solution condition, bucket position	Fresh solution, correctly placed at entrance
Entrance and Surroundings	Debris, pooled water, waste	Clear and clean
Mortality Disposal Point	Proper use and condition	No exposed carcasses
Padlock	Functional and secured	Locked
Pen Boots	Present, clean, correct pen	At right pen entrance, not cross-used
Sawdust and Litter	Particle size, dryness, coverage	Good visible size, dry, evenly spread
Isolation Pen	Cleanliness, separate equipment	Clean, separate feeder and drinker present

19.2 If the inspection is satisfactory, the Farm Manager signs and dates Form D.

19.3 If unsatisfactory, the worker is directed to redo the specific area immediately. The Farm Manager re-inspects before leaving. This is recorded and may attract a sanction. See Section 20.

SECTION 20 SANCTION GRID

20.1 All breaches are recorded in writing, signed by the Farm Manager, and filed in the farm records. The Farm Manager applies sanctions consistently and without exception.

Table 20.1 Disciplinary Sanction Grid

Breach	First Offence	Second Offence	Third Offence
Entering without dipping boots in Disinfectant bucket	Verbal warning. Recorded.	Written warning.	Suspension from poultry unit.
Using external boots inside any pen	Written warning.	Suspension from poultry unit.	Termination.
Using the wrong pen boots in another pen	Verbal warning. Recorded.	Written warning.	Suspension.
Any unauthorised person found inside poultry house	Written warning to worker who permitted entry.	Suspension.	Termination.
Failing to isolate a sick bird within 2 hours	Written warning.	Suspension.	Termination.
Failing to report morning death before 8:00 AM	Verbal warning. Recorded.	Written warning.	Suspension.
Failing to report sick or separated bird same session	Written warning.	Suspension.	Termination.
Reversing entry sequence between pens	Verbal warning. Recorded.	Written warning.	Suspension.
Feeding without inspecting the feed first	Verbal warning. Recorded.	Written warning.	Suspension.
Administering any substance without management approval	Suspension.	Termination.	N/A
Form A not filled or not submitted same day	Verbal warning. Recorded.	Written warning.	Pay deduction for the day.
Cleaning not completed to required standard	Redo task same day. Recorded.	Written warning.	Pay deduction.
Processing or removing birds without instruction	Written warning.	Suspension.	Termination.
Padlock left unsecured	Verbal warning. Recorded.	Written warning.	Suspension.
Disinfectant bucket left empty or unrefreshed	Verbal warning. Recorded.	Written warning.	Suspension.
Using substandard sawdust without reporting	Verbal warning. Recorded.	Written warning.	Suspension.
Farm Manager administering drug without management approval	Written report to CEO. Immediate review.	Escalation to CEO for disciplinary action.	N/A
Farm Manager failing to transfer Notion records before 7PM	Verbal warning. Recorded.	Written warning.	Escalation to CEO.
Farm Manager failing to sign Form A daily	Verbal warning. Recorded.	Written warning.	Escalation to CEO.

DOCUMENT AUTHORISATION

FIELD	DETAIL
Document Title	Poultry Operations Standard Operating Procedure
Organisation	WGNI Farm, Abeokuta, Nigeria
Version	1.0
Date Issued	April 2026
Prepared By	EA Agriculture
Authorised By	CEO, WGNI Farm
Next Review Date	October 2026

This SOP is authorised by the CEO of WGNI Farm. It is subject to periodic review. All workers and managers are expected to know and comply with every section relevant to their role. Ignorance of this document is not an acceptable excuse for non-compliance.

FARM MANAGER SOP ALIGNMENT DECLARATION

I, _____ (Farm Manager Name), hereby confirm that I have fully read, reviewed, and understood the **WGNI Farm Poultry Operations SOP (Version 1.0)**.

I acknowledge that this document outlines the required standards, procedures, and responsibilities governing all poultry operations on the farm. I understand that strict adherence to this SOP is critical to ensuring optimal bird health, operational efficiency, biosecurity, and overall farm performance.

I hereby affirm my full alignment with the contents of this SOP and commit to:

- Implementing all procedures as outlined
- Enforcing compliance among all poultry workers
- Maintaining accurate records and reporting as required
- Upholding the highest standards of farm management and biosecurity

I understand that failure to comply with this SOP may result in disciplinary action as specified within the document.

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: __10__ / __04__ / __2025__